

William Bowman Seton

Official Service and Education Record Evidence Package

Born	1 September 1840, Bombay
Baptised	20 January 1841, St Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay
Parents	Bruce Seton and Emma Seton
Education	Cheltenham College, August 1853 to Christmas 1859
Addiscombe	Nomination/admission papers, 1860
Later evidence	Bombay Military Fund register
Citation	Not supplied; exact archival reference not established from images

Synopsis

William Bowman Seton's papers document the transition from his education in Britain into the East India Company's military training system at Addiscombe, and then provide a later financial/service record from the Bombay Military Fund.

A certified extract from the baptism register of St Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay records that William Bowman Seton was born on 1 September 1840 and baptised on 20 January 1841. His parents were Bruce and Emma Seton. Bruce Seton was recorded in the baptism entry as a Brevet Major. In William's 1860 cadet examination answers his father was described as Colonel Bruce Seton, late of the Bombay Army.

William stated that he had been educated at Cheltenham College and described his education as classical and mathematical. A separate Cheltenham College certificate records that he was a pupil in the Classical and Military Department from August 1853 until Christmas 1859 and that his conduct during that period was very satisfactory.

The nomination file contains the formal Addiscombe nomination papers, William's own examination answers and declarations, supporting recommendation and character letters, and medical certification. A certificate dated 1 June 1860 states that he had been examined as a pupil nominated for the Royal Indian Military College and had qualified for admission. The supporting papers include a character certificate from Chatham dated 9 April 1860 and a medical certificate dated 16 April 1860 declaring him physically fit for military service in a tropical climate.

The final supplied image is a Bombay Military Fund register page headed as a statement of contributions by Major William Bowman Seton. It is a later service and pension-related record rather than part of the Addiscombe nomination file. The page carries annotations recording his retirement on 20 March 1885 and his death on 18 August 1885. It also appears to record an arrival date of 6 April 1862 and a marriage date of 7 February 1878. Because the handwriting and financial entries are densely written, the detailed contribution and promotion entries have not been forced into a full transcription.

Taken together, the papers establish William's Bombay birth and parentage, his lengthy education at Cheltenham, his successful preparation for Addiscombe in 1860, and later service sufficient to generate Bombay Military Fund contributions and retirement records.

Key facts

Fact	Reading	Confidence
Birth	1 September 1840, Bombay	High
Baptism	20 January 1841, St Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay	High
Parents	Bruce and Emma Seton	High
Cheltenham College	Aug 1853 - Christmas 1859	High
Addiscombe admission	Qualified 1 June 1860	High
Medical fitness	Fit for tropical military service, 16 Apr 1860	High
Arrival in later register	6 April 1862	Medium-High
Marriage in later register	7 February 1878	Medium-High
Retirement	20 March 1885	High
Death annotation	18 August 1885	High

Source and citation note

No citation was supplied. The images form two evidential groups: Addiscombe Military College nomination/admission papers and an India Office/Bombay Military Fund register page. The images carry British Library Board copyright markings, but a complete India Office Records series/volume/file reference is not visible. A formal archival citation should therefore remain unresolved until that reference and provider/access details are established.

Document inventory

No.	Renamed file	Description
1	Seton-William-Bowman-01-Addiscombe-Nomination-Cover.jpg	Addiscombe Military College nomination cover.
2	Seton-William-Bowman-02-Cadet-Examination-Part-1.jpg	Cadet examination answers: education, family and nomination details.
3	Seton-William-Bowman-03-Cadet-Examination-Part-2.jpg	Cadet examination declarations and emergency contact details.
4	Seton-William-Bowman-04-Addiscombe-Admission-Certificate.jpg	Certificate of examination and qualification for admission, 1 June 1860.
5	Seton-William-Bowman-05-Recommendation-Letter-26-Mar-1860.jpg	Recommendation letter supporting his nomination, 26 March 1860.
6	Seton-William-Bowman-06-Character-Certificate-9-Apr-1860.jpg	Clergyman character certificate, Chatham, 9 April 1860.
7	Seton-William-Bowman-07-Cheltenham-College-Certificate-7-Apr-1860.jpg	Cheltenham College certificate of attendance and conduct, 7 April 1860.
8	Seton-William-Bowman-08-Bombay-Baptism-Register-Extract.jpg	Certified extract from St Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay baptism register.
9	Seton-William-Bowman-09-Baptismal-Certificate-Reverse.jpg	Reverse of baptismal certificate.
10	Seton-William-Bowman-10-Cadets-Certificate-Nomination-Declaration.jpg	Cadets certificate and declaration concerning the nomination.
11	Seton-William-Bowman-11-Parent-and-Medical-Certificates.jpg	Parent or guardian certificate and medical fitness certificate, April 1860.
12	Seton-William-Bowman-12-Bombay-Military-Fund-Register.jpg	Bombay Military Fund contribution/pension register page, with retirement and death annotations.

Ch. 137 of 1837
L.P. 10.

14 *Bombay Inf*
7 June 61.

No. *137 of 1837*

MILITARY COLLEGE AT
ADDISCOMBE.

NOMINATION.

On the recommendation of *James W. Hutchinson Esq.*
I, *Charles Mills Esq.* hereby
nominate *William Brownson Benson*
as a Cadet for the Military College.

24 March 1861. *Charles Mills*

EAST-INDIA HOUSE.

Passed by the COMMITTEE the *15th April* 1861.

(1)-H-11-26.

EXAMINATION

P.O. 6
Thos
1861

2

INSTRUCTIONS for filling in the Answers. The ANSWERS to the following QUESTIONS must be written by the Cadet himself, in the presence of an Officer of the establishment of the Secretary of State for India in Council.

EXAMINATION

OF

Here insert your Names at full length. } Cadet William Bowman Seton

Question 1. Is the above signature in your handwriting ?
 Answer. Yes.

Here name the School or Schools at which you have been placed since you attained the age of fourteen.
 Question 2. At what School or Schools have you been educated ?
 Answer. Cheltenham College.

Insert whether Classical, Mathematical, or both.
 Question 3. Of what nature has your education been ?
 Answer. Classical and Mathematical.

Question 4. Have you held any employment or Commission in the Army or Navy ?
 Answer. No.

Question 5. What is the profession, situation, and residence of your Father; or, if he be dead, what was his profession, and what is the residence of your nearest of Kin ?
 Answer. My father is a Colonel Bruce Seton, late Bombay Army.

Question 6. Who recommended you to Mr. Mills the Nominating Member of Council, for this appointment ?
 Answer. James Malcolmson Esq.

Question 7. Do you believe that any person has received, or is to receive, any pecuniary consideration, or anything convertible, in any mode, into a pecuniary benefit, on account of your nomination ?
 Answer. No.

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INSTRUCTIONS for Question 8. Are you aware that, if it should be hereafter
filling in the Answers. discovered that your appointment has been
obtained by improper means, you will be
dismissed, and will be ineligible to hold any
situation in Her Majesty's Indian service?

Answer. Yes.

Question 9. Have you been informed that all appointments
now made are to be subject to any altera-
tions that may be decided on?

Answer. Yes.

Question 10. Are you aware, that if you omit to insure the
amount of your passage and outfit, you
do so at your own risk; and that in the
event of loss and damage, by Shipwreck or
other contingency, the Secretary of State for
India in Council will not attend to any
application for indemnification?

Answer. Yes.

Question 11. Have you been furnished with the Articles of
War, and the Regulations of the College, as
also the Terms and the Resolutions of the
late Court of Directors of the 9th August,
1809, and 12th March, 1823, by which latter
Resolution it is required that you shall, *as a*
Condition to your Appointment, subscribe to the
Military Fund at your Presidency, and to the
Military Orphan Fund also, if appointed to
Bengal, to all of which you promise faithfully
to conform?

Answer. Yes.

To be signed by an
Officer on the estab-
lishment of the Secre-
tary of State for India
in Council.

Cadet's
Signature } William Bolmar Seton.

Signed in the
presence of } Wm James Upton.

In case of sudden removal from the College from
sickness or other cause, the Cadet is to be received
by Sir Henry Seton Bonnet, King St., S.E. James
or in his absence by Captain C. H. Seton,
9 Upper Brook Street, Grosvenor Square.

(1)

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 39. Royl. Indⁿ. Milit^y. College.
 Addiscombe S. Indⁿ. 1860.

18

I do hereby certify that I have
 examined.

M^r. Wm. B. Seton.

who has been nominated a pupil
 for the Royl. Indⁿ. Military College,
 and that he is qualified

to be admitted into the above Institution
 to the extent required by the 6th,
 7th and 8th Clauses of the present
 regulations, and that he has been
 admitted accordingly.

Wm. B. Seton

J. Abbott

King's Street
26 March 1860.

My dear Sir,

Availing myself of
your kind promise the other day,
I would ask you for a letter
to the Cadet Office for the
admission to Adiscombe of
William Bowman Seton
son of Colonel Bruce Seton of
Cheltenham, who will be quite
ready to go up in June. His
two Brothers obtained the
Ensigns, and he will most likely
do the same - thus doing credit
to your nomination. Believe me,

My dear Sir, yours very faithfully,
Charles Mills Esq. J. Malcolmson

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I hereby certify that
 William Bowman Seton
 has attended my Church
 along with his family for
 the two years last past,
 and that I have every
 reason to believe that he
 is of good moral
 character ..

(Signed)

Wm. P. Handcock

Minister of the Gospel

Chatham, Mass.

April 9/1860

Chatham

107

I hereby certify that
Mr. William Bowman Seton
has been a pupil in the
Classical and
Military Department of
the Cheltenham College
from Aug. 1853 to Christmas 1859
and that his conduct during
that period has been
very satisfactory.

Thos. A. Southwood M.A.
Head Master, Mil. Department
Cheltenham College.

A. Higham. Principal.
Cheltenham April 7th 1860.

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Certified extract from St Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay baptism register.

Baptisms Solemnized in St. Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay, in the year 1847.

When Baptized.	Said to be Born.	Child's Christian Name.	Sex.	Parents' Names.		Abode.	Quality, Trade, or Profession.	By whom the Ceremony was Performed.
				Christian.	Surname.			
1847. January 20th	1848. September 1st	William Bowman	Male	Bruce and Emma	Edwards	Bombay	Edwards Major	R. G. Hoyle

The above is a true copy of the entry contained in the Register Book of St. Thomas's Cathedral, Bombay. 13th August 1848

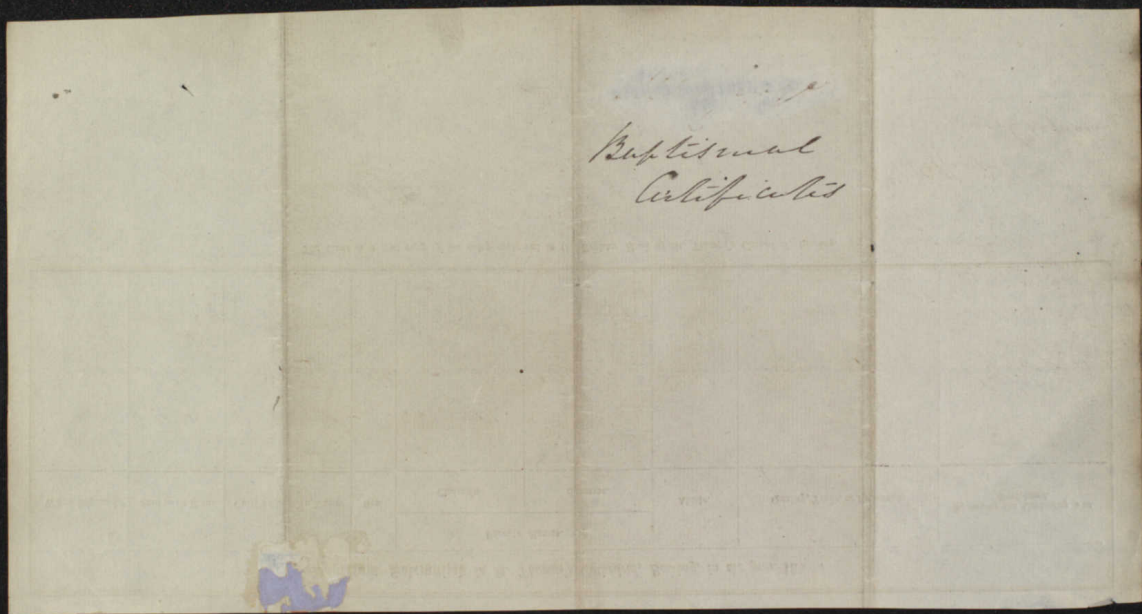
Cathedral Clerk

H. Jefferys
Senior Chaplain

Original image 9 of 12

Reverse of baptismal certificate.

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ADDISCOMBE.

CADETS' CERTIFICATES.

GENERAL CAUTIONS.

First. Notice is hereby given, that, should it be discovered, at the time the Cadet is appointed, or at any subsequent period, that his appointment has been obtained by purchase, or agreement to pay any pecuniary or valuable Consideration whatsoever, either directly or indirectly, when the Appointment is completed, not only will the Cadet be dismissed, and be ineligible to hold any situation in Her Majesty's Indian Forces, but all Persons concerned in procuring the Appointment, or in disposing of, or receiving the same, under such circumstances, will have subjected themselves individually and collectively to a criminal prosecution for a misdemeanour, under the Act of the 49th of George the Third, Chap. 128.

Secondly. The Candidates are desired to present themselves to **Mr. John Hollyer, at the Cadet Office, with their Certificates, as underneath, properly filled up and signed, by Ten o'Clock in the Morning, or as soon after as possible.**

N.B. The following Forms are printed expressly for the purpose of the Blanks being properly filled up and signed previously to the Cadet being nominated.

F I R S T.

The BLANKS in this DECLARATION are to be filled up, and the Paper is to be signed by the person who procures the Nomination.

I do hereby declare, upon my honour, that I received the Nomination of a Cadet for the Military College from (A.) Charles Smith Esq gratuitously and expressly for Mr. (B.) William Bowman Seton to whom I have given it gratuitously; and I also declare that I am well acquainted with his Character, Family, and Connections.

The person recommending is to sign at full length, and to insert his address. W. H. Holchusen 11 April 1866

(A.) Insert the name of the Secretary of State or Member of the Council from whom the Appointment is procured.
(B.) Insert the Christian and Surname of the Person to be appointed a Cadet.

S E C O N D.

EXTRACT from the REGISTER BOOK *

of the Parish of _____
in the County of _____

Resident Clergyman's or Sessions Clerk's Signature. _____

N.B.—The above Extract must be signed by the RESIDENT CLERGYMAN; or if in Scotland, by the SESSIONS CLERK.

* If there is no Register of Birth or Baptism to be found, the Cadet himself must then make a declaration of that circumstance, and of the date of his Birth, the printed form of which may be had in the Cadet Office, for the purpose of being filled up by him previous to his appearing before a Magistrate for that purpose.

(413.)

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T H I R D.

THE PARENTS OR GUARDIAN'S CERTIFICATE.

I do hereby certify, That the foregoing Extract from the Register of Births or Baptisms of the
Parish of Brentford in the County of West End
contains the Date of the birth of my son
William who is the Bearer of this, and nominated a Cadet for the
Military College, by Charles Mills Esq
and I do further declare, that I received the said Appointment for my son William
Bornman Leton through the gratuitous solicitation of
James Alexander Esq and that no Money or other valuable
Consideration has been or is to be paid, either directly or indirectly, for the same; and that I will
not pay or cause to be paid, either now or hereafter, by myself, by my son, or by the
Hands of any other Person, any Pecuniary or valuable Consideration whatsoever, to any Person or
Persons who have interested themselves in procuring the said Nomination for my son;
and I do declare I am fully aware, that if it should be discovered hereafter that the said Appointment
has been obtained by purchase, or by any other unlawful means, he will be subject to dismissal, and
will be ineligible to hold any situation whatever in the Indian Service.

Witness my Hand, this 16th Day of April 1860
in the Year of our Lord _____

The Parent or nearest of Kin alive,
or Guardian, to sign at full length,
and to insert his address.

William Leton
74 Bedford Parade Cheltenham

F O U R T H.

MEDICAL CERTIFICATE.

I have this day carefully examined Mr. William Bornman Leton
and certify that his eyesight and hearing are perfect; that he is without deformity, and has the perfect
use of all his limbs; that he has no appearance of any constitutional disposition or tendency to disease;
and that he does not appear to have any mental or bodily defect whatever to disqualify him for Military
Service in a tropical climate.

London
April 16th 1860

J. H. Martine
J. Stewart Esq Mayor

Medical Examinations will be held at the residence of the Examining Physician (71A, Lower Grosvenor Street,
Grosvenor Square) on the first and third Monday in each month, between the hours of one and two o'clock.

This is to certify, that my son has had the Small Pox, or has been vaccinated.

William Leton

The Blanks in this Certificate must be filled up to correspond with the Certificate of Birth.

To be signed by the Examining Physician and a Military Surgeon.

To be signed by the Parent or Guardian.

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